ACADEMIC CENTRAL

PRACTICE EXAMINATION

GRADE 8

ENGLISH FIRST ADDITIONAL LANGUAGE

PAPER 3 · PRACTICE B

MARKS: 60 **TIME: 2 hours**

Section A: Essay (30) · Section B: Longer transactional text (20) · Section C: Shorter transactional text (10).

Written by Academic Central for practice, following the CAPS curriculum for Grade 8. It is not a Department of Basic Education examination paper.

INSTRUCTIONS AND INFORMATION

1. This question paper consists of THREE sections: SECTION A: Essay (30 marks), SECTION B: Longer transactional text (20 marks) and SECTION C: Shorter transactional text (10 marks).
2. Answer ONE question from EACH section.
3. Write the number and the title of each question you choose.
4. Plan each piece of writing first (mind map, list or rough draft). Your planning must be handed in, but it will not be marked. Draw a line through it when you have finished.
5. Keep to the number of words asked for in each section.
6. Spend about 60 minutes on Section A, 40 minutes on Section B and 20 minutes on Section C.
7. Write neatly and check your spelling, punctuation and paragraphs.

SECTION A: ESSAY

QUESTION 1

Write an essay of 180–220 words on ONE of the topics below. Give your essay a title.

1.1 **The day I was brave** (narrative) [30]

1.2 **A busy taxi rank (or market) early in the morning** (descriptive – use sense images and figurative language) [30]

1.3 **Every learner should do community service before finishing school.** Do you agree or disagree? (argumentative – give at least THREE well-explained reasons) [30]

1.4 **"You learn more from your mistakes than from your successes."** Write an essay about what this saying means to you. You may use your own experiences. (reflective) [30]

1.5 Write a story that ENDS with these words: *"… and that is why I will never open a message from a stranger again."* (narrative) [30]

TOTAL SECTION A: [30]

SECTION B: LONGER TRANSACTIONAL TEXT

QUESTION 2

Choose ONE of the following. Write 100–120 words. Use the correct format and register.

2.1 **Friendly letter.** Your cousin is starting Grade 8 at your school next year and is nervous. Write a letter to your cousin with advice about the first weeks of high school. [20]

2.2 **Dialogue.** Write a dialogue between you and a parent in which you try to persuade him or her to let you join a weekend sports or music club. Use the correct dialogue format. [20]

2.3 **Magazine article.** Write an article for your school magazine with the title "Five ways to beat exam stress". [20]

TOTAL SECTION B: [20]

SECTION C: SHORTER TRANSACTIONAL TEXT

QUESTION 3

Choose ONE of the following. Write 50–70 words. Use the correct format.

3.1 **Invitation.** Write an invitation to the parents of your class to attend the Grade 8 prize-giving. [10]

3.2 **Directions.** A new learner asks you how to get from the school gate to the library. Write clear directions. [10]

3.3 **SMS / WhatsApp message.** Write a message to your teacher to explain why you will be absent from school tomorrow and to ask what work you must catch up on. [10]

TOTAL SECTION C: [10]

TOTAL: 60

END OF QUESTION PAPER